



NEC unveils "Medias W"

Japan's NTT Docomo teamed up with NEC to release new smartphones. Part of the offering, "Medias W" has dual display and is foldable



Temple Run 2

The latest iteration of Temple Run called "Temple Run 2" was downloaded 20 million times in its first four days of launch

Work@Tech

nologies. Apart from this they're also expected to diversify and curate content on the website particularly the user interaction and comments, implement high-quality link building strategies for the websites in their portfolio. SEO also is very much about reverse engineering and second guessing the search engine, skills which can only be accrued and honed after years of experience.

From our previous dichotomy of available job profiles in Analytics, if you're more interested in the technical aspects of things then the companies expect you to be well versed with front-end technologies especially JavaScript. There are a lot of tools/vendors in the market which aid analysts in collecting, organizing and reporting the data viz. Google Analytics, Omniture, IBM Digital Analytics, Webtrends and so on. It's onus on the analytics implementers to make sure that all the systems active on your web properties are completely in sync as errors or miscalibration can lead to catastrophic result. "We look for people who have a logical bend and enjoy number crunching, also they should be willing to work as a part of a team as collaboration is a part of the job profile," adds Rakesh.

As for the degree certification, companies usually don't demand any particular degree but as a minimum the aspirant should possess a Bachelor's degree, a background in science or technology is an added bonus but not a necessity. Along with this some workable knowledge of HTML and JavaScript is expected. As an entry level SEO executive/business analyst you can expect anything from 1.8 lac p.a. to 2.5 lac p.a.; an experienced SEO executive/Analyst stands to rake in a minimum of 4.8 lac p.a. though the exact amount varies from company to company.

Training

A recent survey by Adobe and CMO Council taken by 295 senior marketers in Asia-Pacific show that the industry in the APAC region lags behind its global counterparts in terms of experienced talent. Although we have excellent resources as far as the web development skills go, the marketing teams don't have the right skills and/or experience to handle digital mar-

Certifications

A lot of institutes have come up across India which offer courses and/or certification in SEO and Web Analytics. There are a couple of places online which offer excellent certificate course for a fee.

1. Web Intelligence at University of California - Irvine

This course is a collaboration of the University of California, Irvine Extension, the University of British Columbia Continuing Studies Program and the Digital Analytics Association. It's an award-winning course on digital analytics with courses on data warehousing, business intelligence and other such business topics. The course is completely online and roughly costs about ₹2,27,153. You can find more information about the course at: http://unex.uci.edu/areas/it/web_intel/

2. Market Motive

While the Web Intelligence course at Irvine is more focused on Analytics, Market Motive provides you with an entire gamut of certifications for nearly all paradigms in digital marketing with courses covering fundamentals, search engine optimization, web analytics, conversion optimization, social media marketing, pay per click marketing and digital PR. MM offers a comprehensive self-paced study plan in which all the material

is available online including training videos, lessons, quizzes plus a platform to meet peers from the industry on the website itself. There is no one time fee, but the access costs about ₹16,047 per month. Learn more at: <http://www.marketmotive.com/>

3. Conversion University

This is a free course by Google but it focuses on Google Analytics as opposed to Web Analytics in general. The resources are excellent, it has got both video and text-based lessons to help you become a more knowledgeable Google Analytics user. Google also provides a Google Analytics Individual Qualification which shows your proficiency with the platform. The test is a 90 minutes open book exam, with 80% passing marks. You can access the test at Google Testing Center each test costs roughly ₹2684. The course resides at: <http://www.google.co.in/analytics/iq.html>

Adobe also provides training services and a certificate program for digital marketing aspirants who specialize in working on its Digital Marketing Suite. But as a rule of thumb such courses focus on the tool and won't give you much coverage about the basics which apply to every platform in the wild. Best of luck!

keting strategies at scale but this is partly due to the fact that such corporations suffered from a paucity of hiring budget which prevented them from recruiting senior talent. All in all an experienced SEO expert/analyst will be welcomed with open arms by organizations all around.

When it comes to training it boils down to your ability to grasp the essentials and your aptitude for learning. It is easier for students with technical background to pick up things faster as far as SEO is concerned, while in the case of Web Analytics you need to understand the nitty-gritties of an analytics tool to get a clear picture of what's taking place. Usually a digital marketing agency or an SEO/Analytics Consultancy doesn't limit itself to one particular tool but chooses to work with a vendor which best meets their budget and requirements, so a new entrant has to first train with the experienced staff and find his way around the tool. After understanding the working of the various vendor platforms, an aspirant is bumped

up to design and implement strategies at an industry-level. You usually progress to a vertical after accruing enough experience in dealing with industries.

Conclusion

What we've offered is a glimpse of what is awaiting those of you who are interested in a career in SEO and Web Analytics. Something to look out for here would be business intelligence, which involves providing the management with business specific decisions based on the data coming in from various marketing platforms.

But the digital marketing scene just doesn't end here, we haven't even broached the topics of Paid Search Marketing, Social Media Marketing and Mobile Marketing. There is no denying the fact that digital marketing is poised to bring about a revolution in how people interact with brands and businesses both online and offline, the key is to keep oneself updated and never stop learning. 